

and amortisation (Ebitda), a measure of operating profitability, advanced 39.4% to ₹5,479 crore, and profit margin expanded 469 basis points to 24.7%. One basis point is one hundredth of a percentage point.

For Praveena Rai, Managing Director and CEO of Multi Commodity Exchange of India Ltd (MCX), there are years that test, and then there are years that transform. FY25 was a bit of both for MCX, she said in her annual letter to shareholders. Revenue grew 59% to ₹1,208.86 crore and EBITDA expanded more than 445% to ₹761.51 crore.

It's all about the leadership. "An open-minded approach, empathy in engagement, and courage to take decisions in a dynamic environment are essential leadership qualities," Rai tells *BT*. "It's about empowering teams, nurturing innovation, and fostering a culture of trust where diverse perspectives thrive, driving high performance," she adds.

the electronics manufacturer's strategy centered around creating value by participating in high-growth, high-impact sectors from railways and space to electric mobility, smart metering and semiconductors.

Kaynes' order was ₹6,597 crore at the end of the year. With the acquisition of Iskraemeco India, the company is building full-stack smart meter capabilities and aiming for 15–20% market share, Ramesh told shareholders.

Saloni Satish Wagh's Supriya Lifescience reported record revenue and Ebitda in FY25. Wagh told shareholders that Supriya Lifescience was working on multiple CDMO opportunities across active pharmaceutical ingredients and finished formulations, adding the company's enhanced capacity will be sufficient to support revenue growth through 2027–28. CDMO is short for Contract Development Manufacturing Organisation

Bhuvneswari Nara's Heritage Foods posted a 77% increase in profit and Pavitra Shankar-led Brigade En-

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“ Even the most robust strategy depends on the collective strength and alignment of the people who bring it to life”

VINITA GUPTA, CEO, LUPIN



“ Open-minded approach, courage to take decisions in a dynamic environment are essential leadership qualities”

PRAVEENA RAI, MD & CEO, MCX

LEADING THE STREET

The broader corporate universe reported only a modest uptick in earnings but companies with women at the helm stood out. Against a 9.9% rise in profitability for Nifty 500 companies in FY25, these women-led entities posted a 50–450% surge in profit, shows data compiled by corporate database AceEquity.

Rai's MCX led the pack, with profit surging seven-fold on the back of higher trading volumes and platform upgrades. For her, the three strategic focus areas during the year were operational excellence, compliance, and expansion of products and participants.

Jasleen Kohli's Go Digit followed with a 134% leap in bottom line, reflecting strong underwriting performance and premium growth.

Kaynes Technology India reported a 60% jump in profit. Savitha Ramesh, Executive Chairperson and Whole-time Director, wrote in her annual report that

terprises's profit expanded by 70%. Apollo Hospitals, Kaynes Technology and Garware Hi-Tech Films also reported healthy net income growth.

COST MANAGEMENT, TECH EFFICIENCY

For some of these woman leaders, cost management and tech efficiency was the key to strong results. Kohli said her general insurance company more than doubled its profit in FY25. She attributed the achievement to a disciplined approach to cost management and technology-led efficiencies that enabled her to scale up operations across product lines.

“With data-driven underwriting and sharper risk assessment, we achieved one of the best loss ratios in the industry. Strong investment income and prudent asset management further strengthened our financial position,” she says.

Lupin's Gupta says her leadership journey has been